NORTH SIDE BAPTIST CHURCH · PRIMETIME MINISTRY

Family Matters Handbook

Plan ahead, organize what matters, and start the conversations your family will one day need.

UPDATED 2026



Created by the Family Matters group of the Primetime Ministry at North Side Baptist Church, Weatherford, Texas. Shared with permission by Lisa Keefe, Broker Associate and Seniors Real Estate Specialist®, The Keefe Team · JLA Realty.

About this handbook

The Primetime Ministry offers this handbook to church members, their families, and friends. Use it to plan ahead, organize important information, and start conversations with the people who may one day help carry out your wishes.

This handbook provides general information. For advice about your own situation, consult a qualified attorney, accountant, financial adviser, health care professional, or other appropriate specialist.

TOPICS INCLUDE

- Services of attorneys regarding estates, eldercare, wills, powers of attorney, trusts, probate, Medicaid, Medicare, and other medical directives.
- Estate-related documents and definitions.
- Nursing home care, home care, assisted living, and hospice.
- Last wishes and final arrangements.
- Retirement planning.
- Medicare insurance plans, rules, and regulations.
- Mental health.
- Communication with family, personal representatives (executors), and beneficiaries.

ABOUT THE PROFESSIONALS AND ORGANIZATIONS LISTED

North Side Baptist Church and the Primetime Ministry list these resources for convenience. Inclusion does not imply endorsement or a recommendation. Before choosing a provider, confirm their contact details, services, fees, and any applicable credentials or licensing directly.

Why Lisa shares this handbook

Lisa Keefe is part of the senior adult ministries at North Side Baptist Church, where the Family Matters group created this handbook. As a Seniors Real Estate Specialist® she sits at a lot of kitchen tables where these same questions come up: who has authority to sign, where the papers are, whether to stay or move. The handbook is the church's work, reproduced here with their permission and updated for 2026, because it answers the questions families ask before the real estate question ever comes up.

For the real estate side of these decisions, see **Downsizing in Parker County, Texas** at keefeteamrealty.com/parker-county-downsizing-guide.

Legal Estate Issues and Medicaid

Use this list to prepare questions about estate planning, care decisions, and Texas Medicaid. The Primetime Ministry encourages you to consult an attorney about legal matters.

LEGAL DOCUMENTS NEEDED TO PREPARE FOR INCAPACITY

- Statutory Durable Power of Attorney
- Medical Power of Attorney
- Directives to Physicians (Living Will)
- DNR and Out-of-Hospital DNR

WILLS

- Dying intestate (no will)
- Legal benefits of a will
- Requirements of a will
- Importance for ease of administration (probate)

OTHER TOPICS TO ASK ABOUT

- Probate
- Trusts
- Administration of an estate
- Guardianship and Texas law
- The "talk" with parents
- Dementia
- Texas Medicaid eligibility and pathway to approval

> *A fool's way is right in his own eyes, but whoever listens to counsel is wise.* **Proverbs 12:15**

Estate Related Documents

Gathering and caring for these records is one way to practice Christian stewardship. Consider which documents apply to you, keep them up to date, and make sure the right people know how to find them. An attorney, certified public accountant, or other qualified professional can help you decide what you need.

Will | A legal document accounting for the disposition of assets, and frequently for the care of people. Obtaining legal advice to prepare a will is prudent. When someone dies intestate (without a will), the State (District Court) in which the decedent lived makes decisions that may not reflect the decedent's wishes. You should annually update a personal property list, signed, and dated by you. It is not part of a will but should be kept with it.

Letter of Instruction | A non-legal letter that is helpful to Executors in carrying out final wishes. It is often used in connection with a will.

Durable Power of Attorney | A document authorizing someone to act on your behalf while you are alive. It applies to financial accounts, real property, personal property, and certain business considerations.

Durable Healthcare Power of Attorney | Similar to the durable power of attorney but limited to health care. You may want to consult an attorney about a guardianship document, especially in cases involving dementia.

Advanced Health Care Directive (or Living Will) | Legal document specifying health care decisions when incapacitated. Some hospitals provide these free of charge.

Living Will | Similar to an advanced care directive but usually drawn up by an attorney with much detail.

Authorization to release protected healthcare information | Medical providers frequently provide these documents, known as HIPAA forms.

Trust | A legal document best prepared by an attorney for the benefit of its members and beneficiaries. Typically, there are three types: Revocable, Irrevocable, and Testamentary. A tax attorney is a good resource for trust information.

> *Plans fail when there is no counsel, but with many advisers they succeed.* **Proverbs 15:22**

Estate Related Documents, continued

Real Estate Deed | A document identifying real property being transferred to a new owner. Once recorded, it is evidence of ownership. Different kinds of deeds should be discussed with an attorney before choosing one.

Mortgage and/or Deed of Trust | A document evidencing debt on real property. Deed of Trust is common in Texas.

Income Tax Returns | The IRS recognizes no time limit for retention. Consult a tax professional for retention advice.

Bank Accounts and Investments | Make sure personal representatives and beneficiaries know where this information is and how to access it. Know who is an owner and who is only an authorized user on credit and debit cards.

Debt | Keep current records of all debt, with contact information of your debtors, for your personal representative.

Vehicle Titles | Keep titles secure and accessible.

Insurance Policies | Life, home, auto, etc. should be current and accessible to your personal representative.

Safe Deposit Box and Home Safes | Ensure you and your representative have keys and access authorization.

Stocks, Bonds, All Investments | Evidence of ownership should be current and easily accessible by your representative. Talk to your investment professional for assistance.

Individual Retirement (IRA) and Pension-type Accounts | All account information should be easily accessible by your personal representative. Beneficiary designations should be reviewed annually.

401(K) or 403(B) | All account information should be easily accessible by your personal representative. Beneficiary designations should be reviewed annually.

Partnerships, Corporations, LLC's, etc. | Maintain current records and keep them accessible. They are essential in probate proceedings.

All other accounts, funds, and business arrangements (including verbal) | Keep records current and accessible to your personal representative.

Birth Certificate | Keep a state-certified copy accessible. You can obtain copies from most states' Vital Records Department.

Medical history and other medical records | Make sure these are accessible to your personal representative. Health providers usually have on-line portals with this kind of information.

Marriage License, Divorce Documents, Military Discharge and Prenuptial Agreements | Keep accessible, as personal representatives and beneficiaries frequently need them.

DNR Order | Should be considered early in your life. Discuss with your family, healthcare professional or attorney.

List of all usernames, passwords, and pins | Keep secure and accessible for your representatives.

A testimony of faith | A spiritual legacy you want shared is very important for believers and their loved ones.

Nursing Homes, Assisted Living, and Home Care

Care for those requiring outside help at home or those entering healthcare facilities is a big issue in the USA. An estimated 70% of the population, especially seniors and people with disabilities, will need assistance at some point. Decisions for post-acute care can become necessary at uniquely stressful times. As a person is about to be discharged from a hospital, deciding what's next becomes very important. We recommend learning about options and costs before these times arrive.

Acute care facilities include hospitals, emergency rooms, clinics, and urgent care facilities. Post-acute care facilities include long-term acute care hospitals, inpatient rehabilitation hospitals, skilled nursing facilities, and various home health/hospice and private care services. Inpatient rehabilitation facilities and skilled nursing facilities have differences. We recommend you obtain detailed information before you choose either service.

Senior living communities offer independent living, assisted living, memory care, and continuous retirement care. In-home care is prevalent among many who wish to remain in their homes. Before arranging care, check Medicare, Medicaid, and any other coverage, and ask what you would pay out of pocket. You can use Medicare.gov's provider comparison tool to look up care options.

Local home health resource
Aviator Home Health · Contact: Laschell L. Tompkins, Senior Account Manager

> *Don't discard me in my old age. As my strength fails, do not abandon me.* **Psalm 71:9**

Last Wishes and Final Arrangements

Talk with your loved ones about your final arrangements and the legacy you want to leave, whether public or private. Planning ahead gives them a clearer picture of your wishes. A pastor or other qualified professional can help you think through your options.

You can call the Weatherford funeral homes below to ask about services and advance planning. The church office also offers *When a Loved One Passes Away*, a booklet that walks families through the planning process.

Whites Funeral Homes
130 Houston Ave.
Weatherford, TX 76086
(817) 596-4811

Galbreaith-Pickard Funeral Chapel
913 N. Elm St.
Weatherford, TX 76086
(817) 594-2747

Additional local resource: Browning Funeral Home
116 Wheeler St., Weatherford, TX 76086 · (682) 804-8044 · www.browningfuneralhome.com

WILLED BODY PROGRAMS

Some people choose to donate their bodies to medical science. If you consider this option, three such programs from leading institutions are below.

University of North Texas Willed Body Program
Health Service Center
3500 Camp Bowie Blvd.
Fort Worth, TX 76107
(817) 304-3763
WilledBodyProgram@unthsc.edu

UT Southwestern Medical Center Willed Body Program
5323 Harry Hines Blvd.
Dallas, TX 75390-9143
(214) 648-2221
www.utsouthwestern.edu

Texas Tech University Health Sciences Center · Institute of Anatomical Sciences, Willed Body Program
3601 4th St., Stop 6528, Lubbock, TX 79430 · (806) 743-2708 · wbp.lubbock@ttuhsc.edu

> *Honor your father and mother, which is the first commandment with a promise.* **Ephesians 6:2**

Planning for Retirement

FOUR BROAD PRINCIPLES TO HELP REACH RETIREMENT GOALS

1. Start building your nest egg early.
2. Study and learn the principles of wealth management.
3. Develop a long-term plan and commit to it.
4. Be sure your plan is based on sound biblical principles.

FIVE KEYS TO HELP REACH RETIREMENT GOALS

1. Realize any financial plan should begin with faithful and proportional giving to God's kingdom. Malachi 3:6-10 is foundational to kingdom stewardship.
2. Develop a budget which includes short-term savings. Systematic contributions to a readily accessible account, such as those offered by banks and credit unions, is important.
3. Life insurance and medical insurance play a vital role in reaching your goals. A discussion with a professional is recommended regarding various kinds of insurance and your needs.
4. It is best to start contributing early to a plan which includes investments suited to meet your goals. A professional financial advisor can provide help. Navigating the world of financial investments can be risky. We recommend you seek wise counsel from an experienced Christian professional.
5. Finally, understand the place of employer-offered retirement plans, individual retirement plans, and even Social Security. Many financial information sources are available; some of these are listed below.

LOCAL

Brandon Garrett, CFP, CIMA, AIF
201 Ft. Worth Hwy, Weatherford, TX 76086
817-550-6750

Don Hubbard, Financial Planner
903 N Main St., Weatherford, TX 76086
817-594-6556

NATIONAL

Dave Ramsey, noted author, speaker, and host of The Ramsey Show · ramseysolutions.com
Wealth management departments at financial institutions.

> *I will be the same until your old age, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will bear and rescue you.* **Isaiah 46:4**

Medicare

Medicare is a government-sponsored insurance program. The following is a quote taken from medicare.gov.

> "Medicare is health insurance for people 65 or older. You're first eligible to sign up for Medicare 3 months before you turn 65. You may be eligible to get Medicare earlier if you have a disability, End-Stage Renal Disease (ESRD), or ALS (also called Lou Gehrig's disease)."

Medicare consists of three parts:

1. Part A (hospital insurance)
2. Part B (medical insurance)
3. Part D (drug coverage)

Many people also obtain supplemental coverage. Medicare Advantage (also known as Part C) is a Medicare-approved plan from a private company offered as an alternative to Medicare.

The publication *Medicare and You* includes information to help you understand both options. Contact the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services to obtain a copy of this material.

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services
7500 Security Blvd., Baltimore, MD 21244-1850 · medicare.gov

We recommend contacting an insurance professional to assist with your Medicare needs.

> *The righteous thrive like a palm tree and grow like a cedar tree in Lebanon. Planted in the house of the Lord, they thrive in the courts of our God. They will still bear fruit in old age, healthy and green, to declare, "The LORD is just; he is my rock, and there is no unrighteousness in him."* **Psalm 92:12-15**

Mental Health

Mental health concerns affect individuals, families, and the people who care for them. North Side Baptist Church recognizes the need for mental health care and pastoral support. Health care providers and, when appropriate, legal professionals can help families address more complex needs. The Family Matters Ministry aims to work with the church's senior pastors to involve qualified professionals in future workshops and talks.

Family Matters, Communication, and "The Other Talk"

"The Other Talk" is a family conversation about end-of-life wishes. Start while there's time to listen, ask questions, and talk through personal or family concerns. It's one way to care for the people who may have to make decisions on your behalf.

REASONS FOR "THE OTHER TALK"

- It is biblical. Exodus 20:12; 1 Timothy 3:5-8; Ephesians 6:1-4.
- It can preserve family relationships and unity. (It may take more than one talk to reach an understanding and agreement.)
- It helps families plan how to transfer assets.
- It encourages prayerful consideration.

THINGS TO DO BEFORE "THE OTHER TALK"

- Pray and seek God's will.
- Make a list of all topics.
- Set goals.
- Gather all the essential documents.
- Make all people aware of the talk, including pastors and other professional advisors.
- Consider what commitments others might be willing and able to make.
- Plan for any additional meetings.
- Compile a list of contacts and which services are needed.
- Plan for leaving a legacy. It may include family history, a chronicle of life events, or anything else important to those involved. It is a good time to formalize plans for any material legacy to be left.
- Appoint someone to record or journal all meetings.

> *Honor your father and mother, which is the first commandment with a promise, so that it may go well with you and that you may have a long life in the land.* **Ephesians 6:2-3**

Notes

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910 North Main Street
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www.nsbcweatherford.com
(817) 599-8612

Family Matters Handbook, Primetime Ministry. Updated 2026. General information only; consult a qualified professional about your own situation.

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Texas law requires license holders to provide the Information About Brokerage Services and Consumer Protection Notice: keefeteamrealty.com/iabs-consumer-protection-notice.pdf